

KALE REALTY

27% BLAME AFFORDABILITY. 12% BLAME INVENTORY.

Realtors picked the real reason buyers stall this year.

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MOST AGENTS BLAME A STALLED BUYER ON RATES.

REALTORS surveyed nationally didn't rank rates first. They ranked affordability, more than double the next answer.

THE INDUSTRY'S OWN MEMBERS NAMED THE BLOCKER, AND IT ISN'T THE ONE MOST AGENTS LEAD WITH.

NAR's 2026 Member Profile asked REALTORS what most limits their clients from buying. Housing affordability topped the list at 27 percent, more than double lack of inventory at 12 percent and difficulty finding the right property at 11 percent. Rates never top that list. If the people doing the deals say affordability is the real objection, a buyer conversation built around "let's wait for rates to drop" is answering a question nobody asked.

WHAT TO CHANGE ABOUT THIS MONTH'S BUYER CONVERSATIONS:

- 1 Open with the payment, not the price.**
Put the total to close and the monthly cost as line one of the CMA, before the listing photos.
- 2 Bring a lender to the first buyer call.**
Rate buydowns and down-payment assistance are the actual affordability levers, not a rate cut you can't control.
- 3 Recalibrate the search criteria before the tour.**
Have the affordability conversation before three rejected offers force it.

THE TAKEAWAY

BUYERS AREN'T WAITING ON THE MARKET.

They're waiting on a way to afford it.